

Brand Book

Welcome to our **KS&R** Brand Book. We're happy you're here.

In this book you'll find everything you need to know about how the **KS&R** brand works as well as what we stand for. More than just a style guide, this book sets out the vision and values of our firm along with the unique beliefs and behaviors that underpin our Brand.

For that reason, we encourage all of our staff and colleagues to familiarize yourself with this document so that we can consistently and collectively deliver on our Brand's promise. After all, **KS&R** isn't simply a logo. It's our people, our approach, and our culture that makes us who we are.

With that in mind, we ask that these verbal and visual principles be adhered to whenever and wherever we communicate our Brand – online or in person.

While our Brand Marketing & Communications team is always available to answer any questions you may have about this guide, it's the duty of all of us to maintain the integrity of our Brand, and ensure the continued success of **KS&R**.

Thanks for joining us on this journey.

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Introduction

In every industry.
Every market.

Competition is not
just present.

It's overwhelming.

There is an abundance
of choice for consumers.

That abundance of choice
means companies must find
ways to stand out in today's
crowded marketplace.

When it comes to the world of research and consulting, we are faced with a sea of sameness.

This pattern of sameness presents us with a unique opportunity for differentiation. To not only stand out but to tell a powerful story.

KS&R must lead with a brand that's as forward-thinking as the research we champion.

For the decision-makers at Fortune 500 companies, a good product or service is a baseline expectation.

What they're increasingly tuned into is brands that garner trust. It's about evoking emotion. Sparking an interest. And creating a sense of belonging.

They don't just want a provider or a partner.

They want to be part of something.

First impressions are our single opportunity to communicate who we are at our core. Especially to those who have never worked with us.

It's not just about telling our story. It's about telling it in the most compelling, unforgettable way.

It's our moment to make them feel something lasting about **KS&R**.

Our story extends
beyond the words we say.

If our visual identity
doesn't align with our verbal
narrative, we risk the trust and
connection we aim to build.

Every touchpoint. Every piece
of communication. Must be
a mirror reflecting the essence
of our brand.

Seamlessly blending what
we say with what we convey.

Each of us plays a fundamental role in shaping how the **KS&R** brand is presented to the world.

Let's walk this journey together.



Brand Story

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Strategic Narrative

KS&R is more than a market research firm.

Our bedrock credibility combined with our relentless pursuit of innovation gives us the permission to be equally assertive in the way we talk about how and why we do the work we do.

It's not just solving complex problems to allow our clients to make better decisions. It's creating authentic value.

It's showing them not just what's behind the doors on this floor. It's leading them to new floors of the house.

Strategic Pillars

Thought Leadership.

Rapidly evolving markets requires us to prove our commitment to leadership in the industry, with the dedication of time and resources that demonstrate our intellect.

Not only executing thought leadership, but loudly and consistently proclaiming it will elevate our position and prominence.

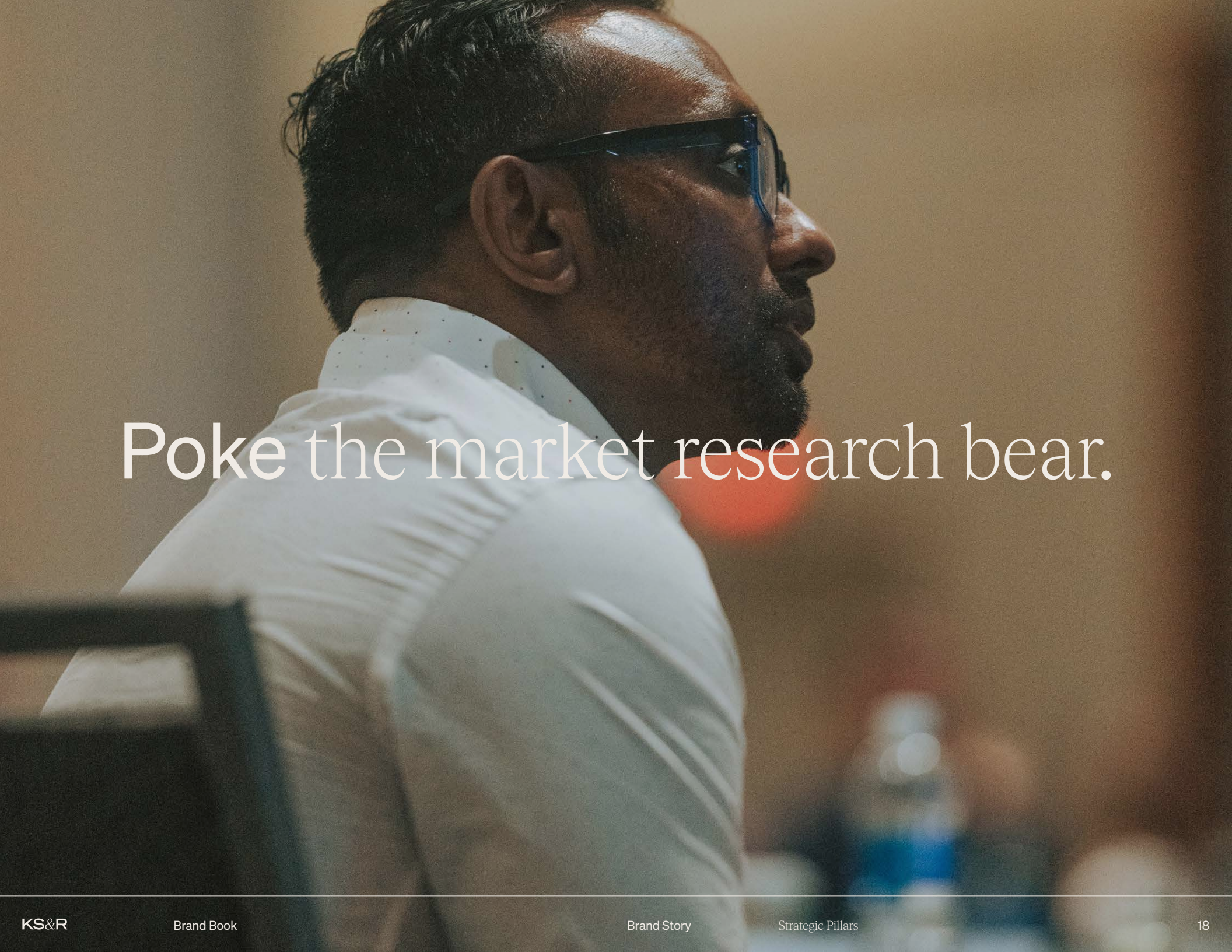


Simply Smarter.

Provocative Innovation.

Our spirit of willingness to take on the hard problems with passion and innovation translates into our ability to do things no one else can do.

Celebrating that permits us to come from a place of accessible disruption and question the conventions associated with market research.

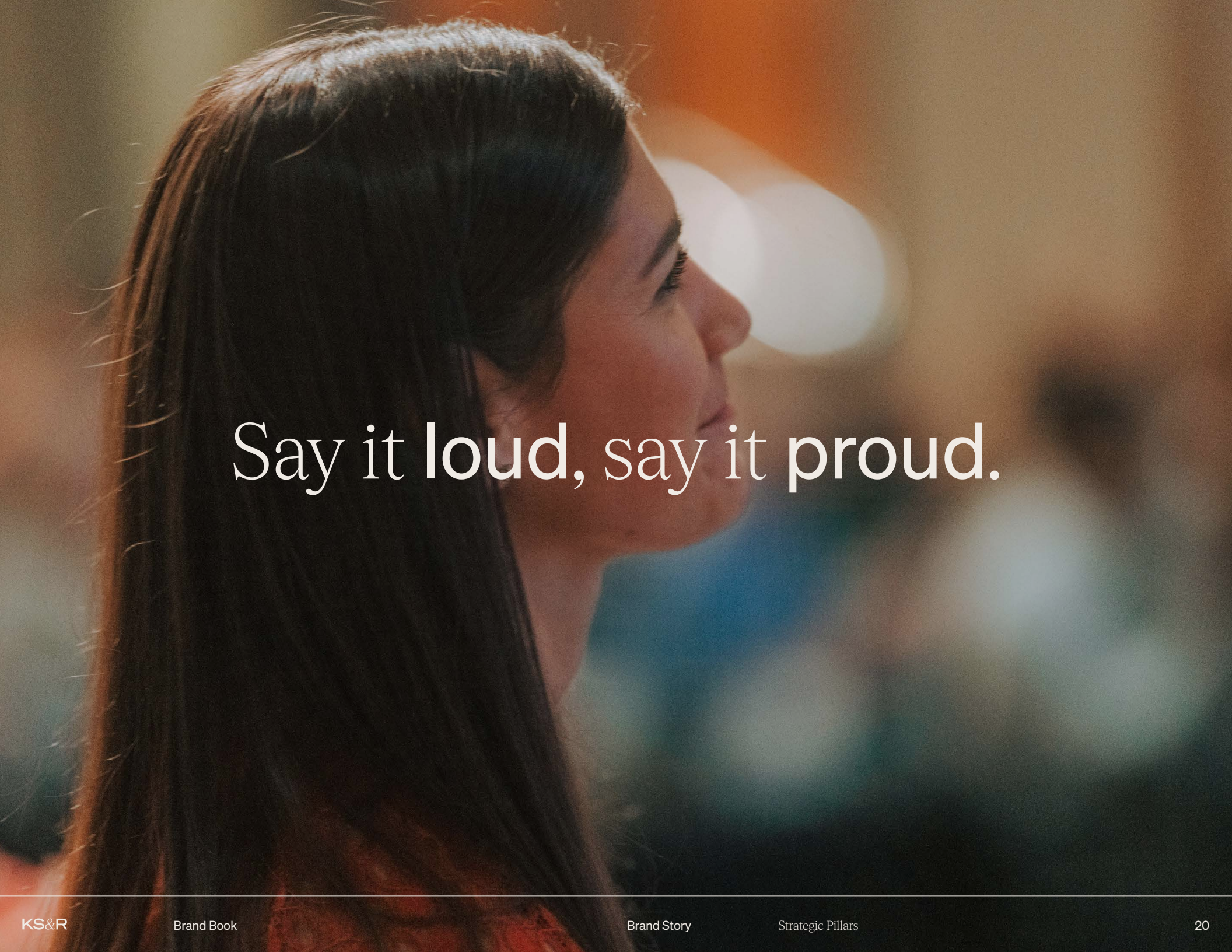
A close-up, profile shot of a man with dark skin and a beard, wearing glasses and a white shirt. He is looking towards the right side of the frame. The background is blurred, showing warm, indoor lighting.

Poke the market research bear.

Vocal Advocacy.

We have a widely recognized but untapped history of client service that borders on devotional.

Leverage it into the perception of being advocates not just for our clients, but their challenges at hand, using it as the foundation upon which to build the reputation for advocacy for their businesses and the industry at large, as well.

A close-up, profile shot of a woman with long, dark, wavy hair. She is looking upwards and to the right with a slight smile. The background is blurred, showing warm, bokeh light effects. The text "Say it loud, say it proud." is overlaid in a white, serif font.

Say it loud, say it proud.

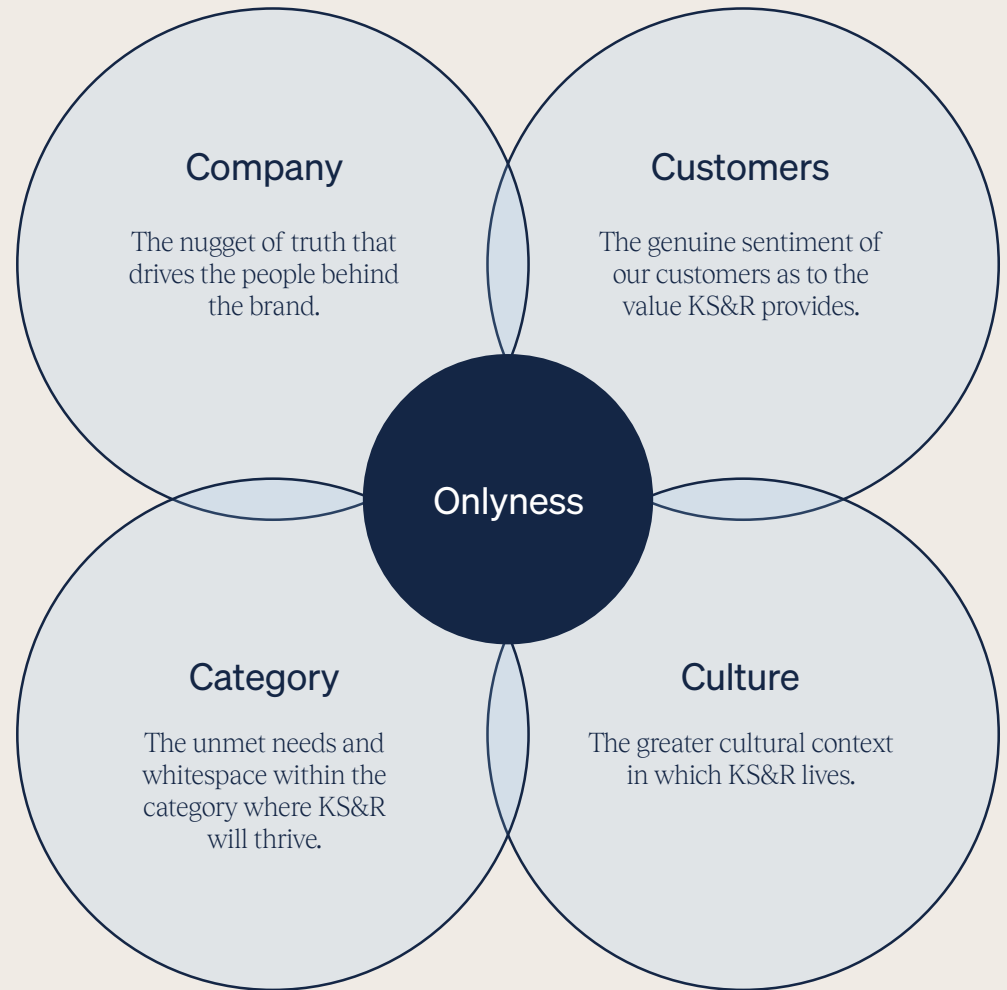
Brand **Keystone**

A photograph of two men shaking hands. The man on the left is wearing a white long-sleeved shirt and glasses. The man on the right is wearing a dark blue zip-up jacket and has a name tag. They are both smiling. The background is blurred, showing other people in a room.

Dynamic wisdom that
drives business.

The Four Forces & Onlyness

The Four Forces (Insights)



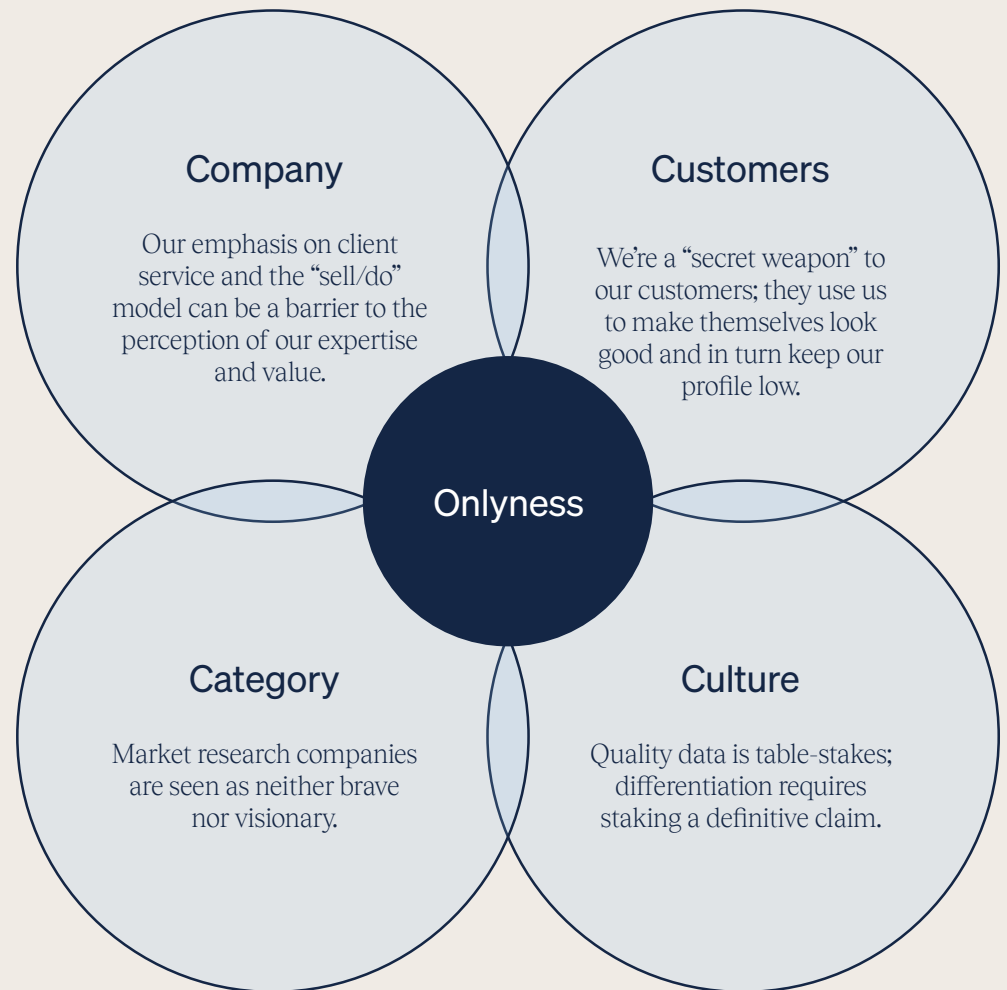
Let's agree on what an **onlyness** is.
And isn't.

An onlyness is the thing that sets KS&R apart. It's the intersection of the insights behind our company, the customers, the category, the competition and the culture. We believe an onlyness is the most foundational building block of our brand, because it's the fundamental white space where the KS&R brand will thrive.

It functions like a positioning statement, but amplified. It's the magnetic north to guide communication with the brand's audiences, and it's also **aspirational** — it's not a specific intersection in time, but rather a place to be consistently striving towards.

An onlyness is **never intended to face our audiences**, and it's never a tagline.

The Four Forces (Insights)



Our Onlyness

KS&R is the only strategic partner focused on the intersection of expertise, insights, and innovation to drive better decision making.

Our Onlyness (Deconstructed)

We are not a market research firm. We are not an ivory tower consultancy. We are committed and invested in our clients business, with obsessive customer service.

KS&R is the only **strategic partner** focused on the **intersection** of **expertise, insights, and innovation** to **drive better decision making.**

The unique “sweet spot” within the industry we’ve created.

We do what we do in service of something greater than simply research: to help our clients confidently make the best possible decisions for their business.

Our expertise comes from tremendous experience and knowledge in industry verticals. Our insights are the kindling that inspire us to action. And innovation is our eye towards the future, carefully considering what the world looks like next.

Our Brand Keystone & Onlyness

Brand Keystone

Dynamic wisdom that
drives business.

The real value we offer our customers. How we do it.

Onlyness

KS&R is the only strategic
partner focused on the
intersection of expertise,
insights, and innovation to
drive better decision making.

How we do it.

Purpose, Vision & Mission



Purpose

Empower our clients to make better decisions with confidence.

Vision

To impact and influence business results through the combination of our experience, insights, and innovation.

Mission

A world where the success of our clients is rooted in dynamic wisdom.

Our Values

Biased to Action.

Our work is not academic; we're committed to experimentation and innovation, changing behaviors and impacting business results with the insights we mine.

We are constantly in the pursuit of growth: for our people, for our firm, and for our clients, existing and future, and their business.

Relentless Curiosity.

We are innately curious.

We ask the right questions to find the right answers, and we keep digging until we get there.

We continually ask “why” to gain clarity and depth.

Customer Obsession.

Our passionate commitment to our clients builds total confidence, helping them to mitigate risk and take the proper steps to grow their business.

We offer personal touch with global capabilities.

Community Centric.

We care deeply for
the future of the industry,
our people and the cities
we call home.

We work hard to build
a close-knit team, and to take
care of our communities.

Tone of Voice

Customer-centric

Everything we talk about, and everything we do, ties back to our customers. We are servant-hearted, going above and beyond to give them the best work, but also the best experience possible when working with KS&R.

#Inquisitive
#Collaborative
#Reliable
#Dependable

Proud Advocates

We are proud of the work we do, both KS&R and in partnership with our clients. And despite that work often being undervalued, we continue to advocate for the need for market research and the value that we bring. Because this work is tangible and actionable, we work toward changing businesses, not just talking about change.

#Passionate
#Supportive
#Challenging (of the status quo)
#Caring

Wise

Our clients work with us because they trust us and our expertise. But we don't come off as know-it-alls or smarty-pants, even if we are the smartest people in the room. We project our confidence through intelligently educating others to bring our clients and their colleagues along for the ride, moving them toward business-changing action.

#Guiding
#Confident
#Knowledgeable
#Trustworthy
#Expert

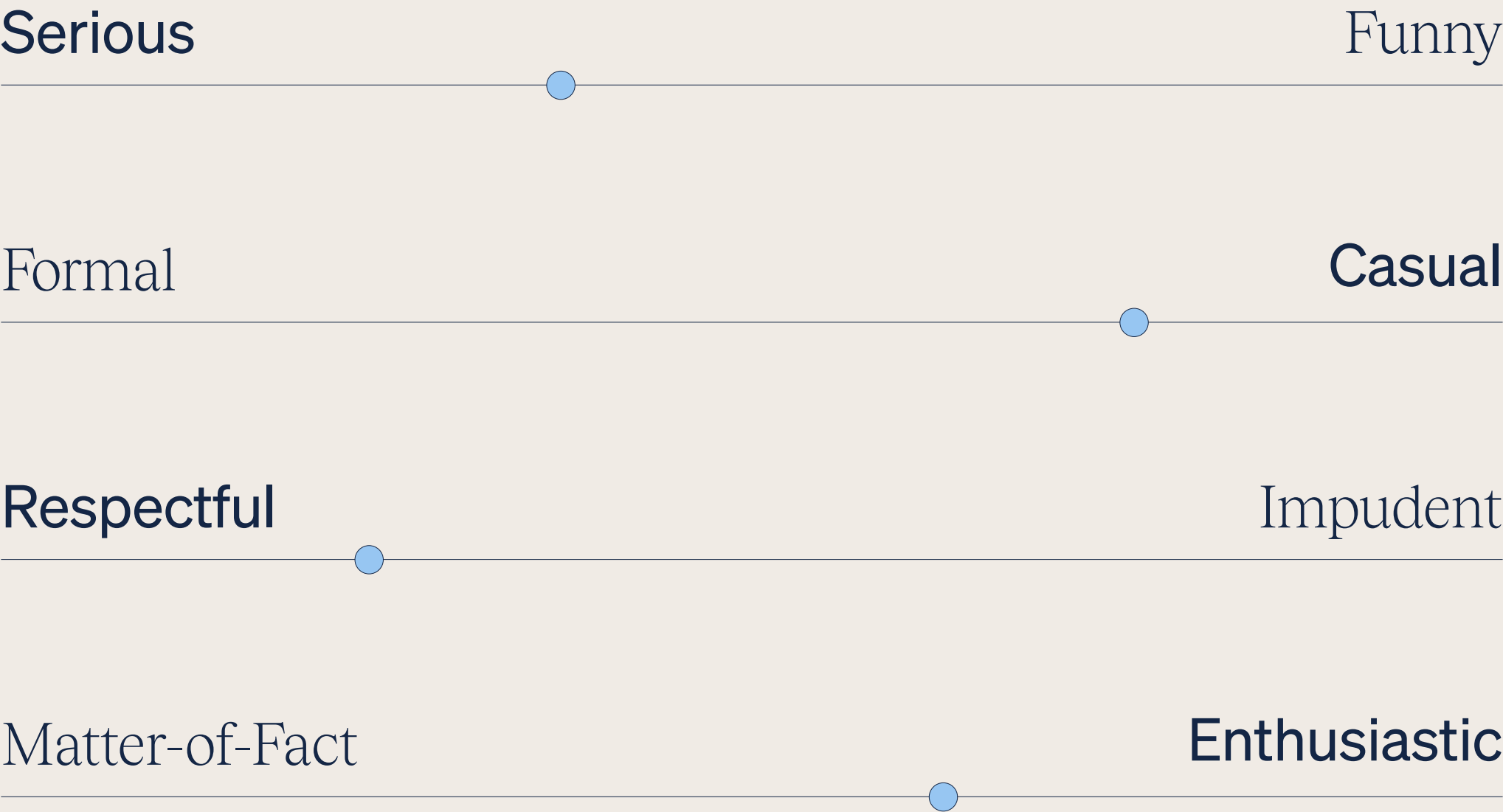
Visionary

With deep knowledge resulting from decades in the industry but always with an eye toward the future, we have monitored trends and developed innovative solutions that can disrupt the current trajectory of the market research industry.

#Insightful
#Focused
#Aspirational
#Enthusiastic

The tone of voice is a critical element that shapes its identity and connects with its audience. It encompasses the specific style, attitude, and emotional undertones that the brand communicates through its language and messaging.

The tone of voice reflects the brand's core values and personality. By consistently applying a distinctive tone of voice, a brand can foster stronger relationships, build trust, and create a memorable presence in the minds of its customers.



Inquisitive.
Collaborative.
Reliable.
Dependable.
Passionate.
Supportive.
Challenging.
Caring.

Guiding.
Confident.
Knowledgeable.
Trustworthy.
Expert.
Insightful.
Focused.
Aspirational.

Tagline

A man with grey hair, wearing a teal blazer over a light blue button-down shirt, is speaking into a black microphone. He is gesturing with his right hand, palm up. The background is a blurred indoor setting with warm lighting and a red light source visible in the lower right.

Dynamic Wisdom Empowering
Better Decisions.

Manifesto

Most people think of research as being black and white.
To us, it's a whole lot more.
Because our work isn't just about asking questions,
it's about asking the right questions.

It isn't just about finding answers,
It's about what you do with those answers.

Our work has the potential to open eyes.
To paint the world in a new light.

Enable you to see what you couldn't before
so you can approach opportunity from a new angle.

It's more than reporting back information.
It's a revelation, one that adds color and clarity
To every decision you make moving forward.

We take you on a journey,
a pursuit to find the optimal path.

Armed with knowledge, wisdom,
and a dose of instinct, we don't just
illuminate that path, we walk it with you.

Because we believe what starts with curiosity
should always culminate in confidence.

At KS&R, we power your pursuit.

Brand Identity

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Logotype

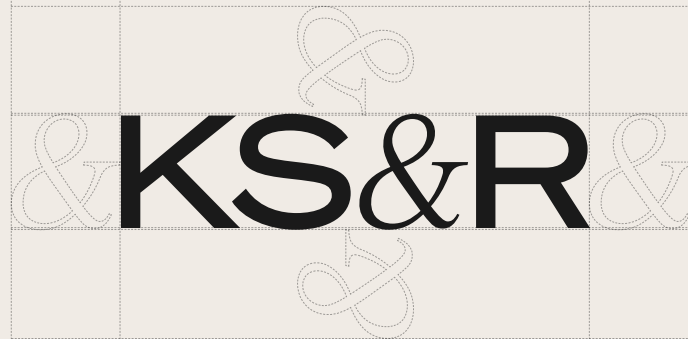
The logotype is designed to be recognizable and transmit something at first look. It gives the brand a fresh breath of air and highlights the strong connection between the company and its people. The “and” is elevated as a key element to turn it into an important resource for the visual identity.

The logotype 'KS&R' is displayed in a large, bold, black serif font. The letters 'K', 'S', and 'R' are in a heavy, blocky style, while the ampersand '&' is more ornate and elegant, featuring a small loop and a thin, curved line that connects the letters. The overall design is clean and professional.

The logo is constructed with a grid system that ensures precise alignment and spacing. The bold sans-serif letters are contrasted by an elegant serif ampersand. The logo is divided by vertical and horizontal grid lines, maintaining uniform letter heights and consistent spacing.

The image shows the 'KS&R' logo centered on a light gray grid. The grid consists of 6 vertical columns and 4 horizontal rows. The letters 'K', 'S', and 'R' are in a bold, black, sans-serif font, each occupying one full column. The ampersand '&' is in a black, elegant serif font, positioned between the 'S' and 'R' columns. The entire logo is aligned with the horizontal lines of the grid, specifically between the second and third rows from the top.

The vertical and horizontal clear space is defined by the width of the ampersand, keeping it at the same scale as the wordmark. No other elements should intrude into this area.



Ensuring readability and recognition requires setting minimum size standards for both print and digital formats:

- Minimum print size: 3/4 inch wide
- Minimum digital size: 96 pixels wide

KS&R

(Print) 3/4"

KS&R

(Digital) 96px

In most applications, the logo is placed on the left corner of the layout.

It is usually placed on the bottom of the artwork, but it can also be placed on the top left corner when there are no other elements in the same line as the logo.

When there are no other elements in the design, the logo can be placed in the center of the layout.



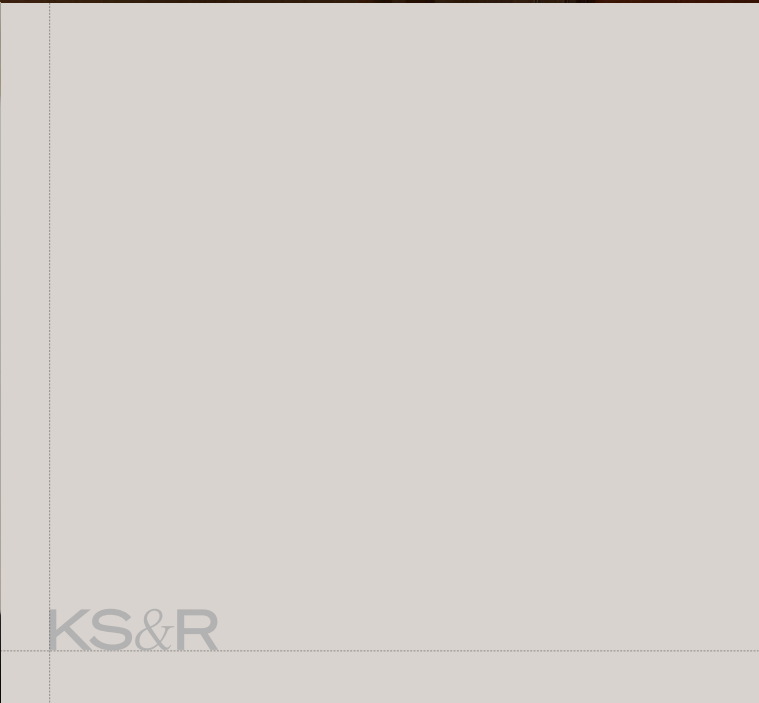
When using the logo on an image with no other elements, it will be placed in the center.

When using multiple elements on an image, the logo will go on the bottom left corner.

The use of photography must allow readability fo all elements present.



Center Use



Bottom Left Corner Use

These are examples of misuse
of the logo:

- 1. Do not resize elements
- 2. Do not distort
- 3. Do not recompose
- 4. Do not add shadows or effects
- 5. Do not use in outlines
- 6. Do not rotate



(Do not resize elements)

(Do not distort)

(Do not recompose)



(Do not add shadows or effects)

(Do not use in outlines)

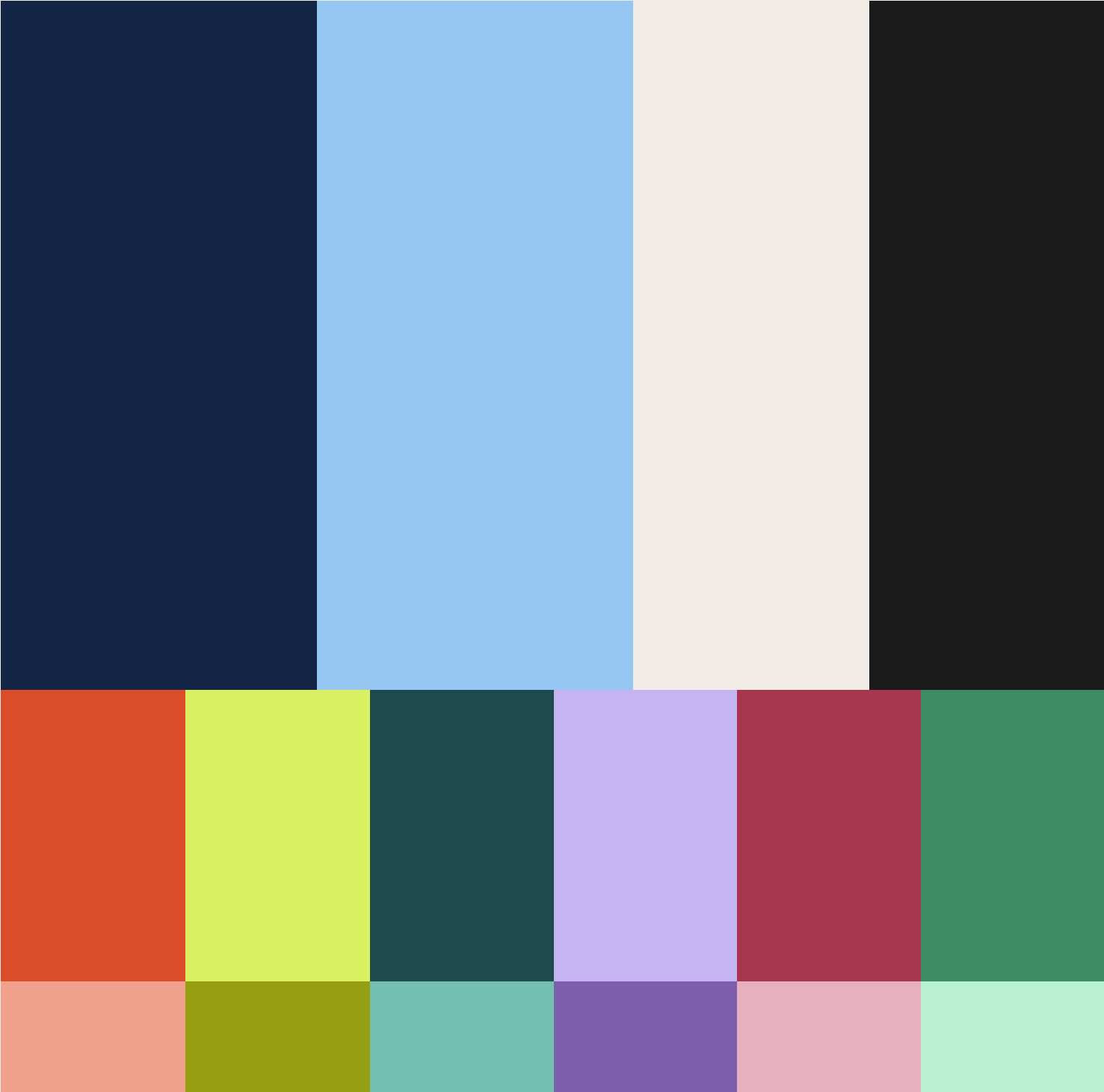
(Do not rotate)

Colors

We have outlined a variety of primary and secondary colors. This diverse color palette creates vibrancy for our brand.

The two blues are our main corporate colors, with a secondary and tertiary palette to identify industries and add variety to our identity.

This chromatic hierarchy can be applied to internal and external scenarios.

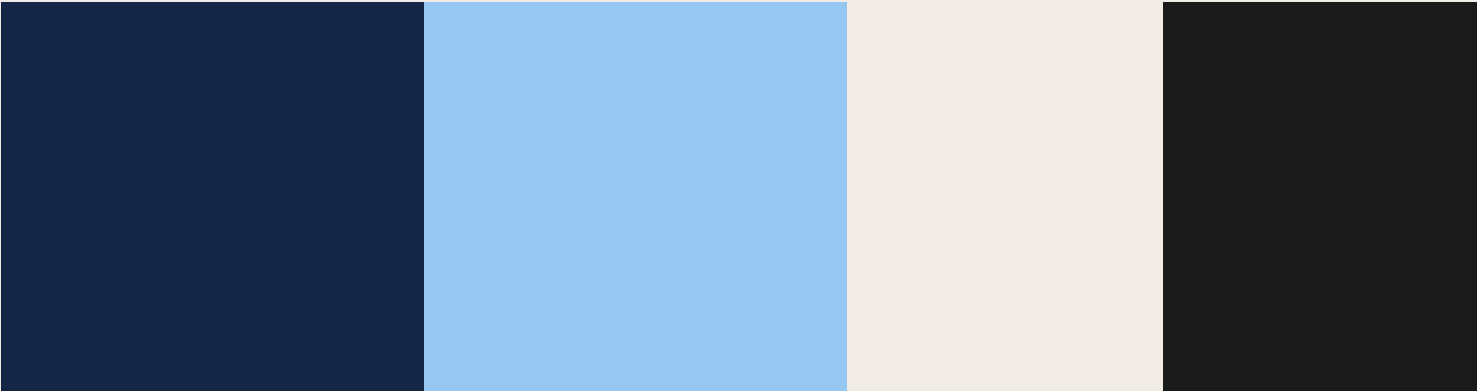


Our primary brand colors are light and dark blue combined with black and white, as needed.

Each secondary color has been assigned to an industry team to more clearly communicate on behalf of each team in a unique way.

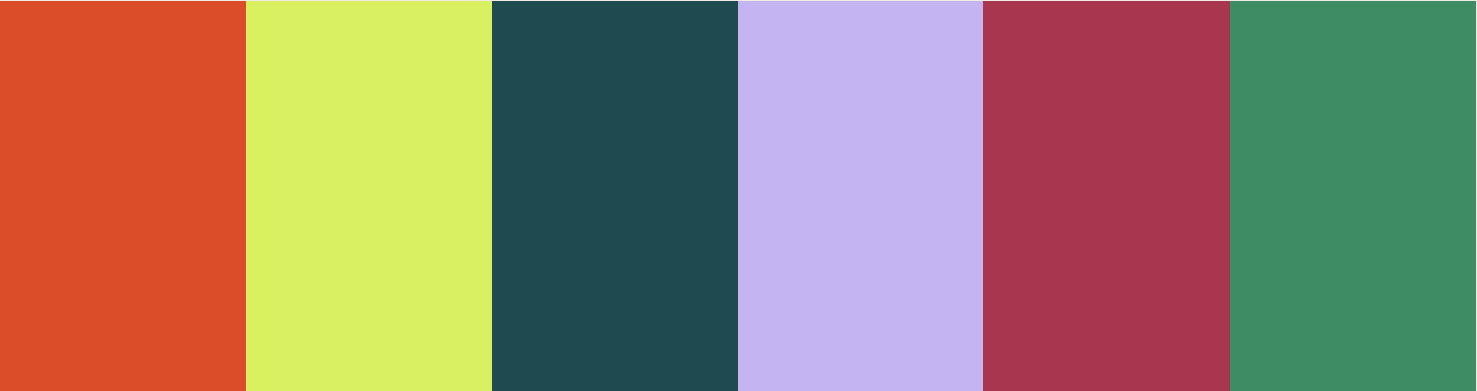
Tertiary colors are to be combined with the corresponding secondary colors when contrast is needed.

Primary



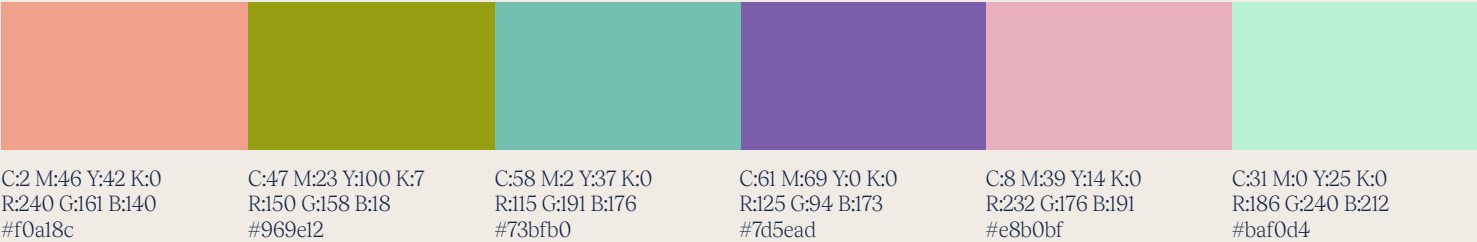
C:100 M:860 Y:42 K:47 R:20 G:38 :B:69 #142645	C:44 M:13 Y:0 K:0 R:151 G:198 :B:242 #97c6f2	C:7 M:7 Y:11 K:0 R:240 G:235 B:229 #f0ebe5	C:76 M:67 Y:61 K:83 R:26 G:26 B:26 #1a1a1a
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Secondary



Business Services	Technology	Healthcare	Telecom, Entertainment & Recreation	Retail & E-Commerce	Transportation & Logistics
C:8 M:80 Y:89 K:1 R:219 G:77 B:41 #db4d29	C:24 M:0 Y:72 K:0 R:217 G:240 B:97 #d9f061	C:85 M:48 Y:51 K:47 R:31 G:74 B:79 #1f4a4f	C:28 M:32 Y:0 K:0 R:196 G:181 B:242 #c4b5f2	C:24 M:88 Y:50 K:18 R:168 G:54 B:79 #a8364f	C:077 M:23 Y:71 K:7 R:61 G:140 B:99 #3d8c63

Tertiary



C:2 M:46 Y:42 K:0 R:240 G:161 B:140 #f0a18c	C:47 M:23 Y:100 K:7 R:150 G:158 B:18 #969e12	C:58 M:2 Y:37 K:0 R:115 G:191 B:176 #73bfb0	C:61 M:69 Y:0 K:0 R:125 G:94 B:173 #7d5ead	C:8 M:39 Y:14 K:0 R:232 G:176 B:191 #e8b0bf	C:31 M:0 Y:25 K:0 R:186 G:240 B:212 #baf0d4
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The following outlines the approved color combinations of the logo.

The logo can only be used in three colors:

- Main navy blue
- Main light blue
- White / Black

The logo can be combined in the following ways:

- Navy background with light blue logo
- Light blue background with navy logo
- Secondary dark backgrounds with white logo
- Secondary light backgrounds with navy logo



The main colors can be combined within themselves.

Each industry color can only be combined within the industry's secondary and tertiary colors, not mixed with other industries.

The text and logo will only be used in the brand's white, black or dark blue, depending on the background.

The image displays a grid of six color swatches, each featuring the letters 'Abc', a line of placeholder text, and the 'KS&R' logo. The swatches are arranged in a 3x2 grid. The top row shows dark blue and light blue. The middle row shows orange and yellow. The bottom row shows purple, red, and green. Each swatch has a horizontal line above the text and the logo below it.

Color	Text Color	Logo Color
Dark Blue	Light Blue	Light Blue
Light Blue	Dark Blue	Dark Blue
Orange	White	White
Yellow	Dark Blue	Dark Blue
Dark Green	White	White
Purple	Dark Blue	Dark Blue
Red	White	White
Green	Dark Blue	Dark Blue

These are examples of misuse of the brand colors:

- 1. Low Contrast
- 2. Mixing industry colors
- 3. More than 2 colors
- 4. Industry colors for text & wordmark

The approved color combinations may not be altered under any circumstances to ensure consistency.



(Low contrast)



(Mixing industry colors)



(More than 2 colors)



(Industry colors for text & wordmark)

Typography

Brand Typography:

Tobias and Sohne are the selected fonts for external marketing materials including digital, PDFs, images, and print use.

System Typography:

Arial and Times New Roman are the selected fonts for company-wide internal use for applications such as word documents and email use.

Brand Typography

Tobias Light

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
1234567890* @()! ?&+ →←↓↑®

Sohne Buch

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
1234567890* @()! ?&+ →←↓↑®

System Typography

Times New Roman Regular

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
1234567890* @()! ?&+ →←↓↑®

Arial Regular

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
1234567890* @()! ?&+ →←↓↑®

Tobias is used in extended headlines,
always in Light weight.

A negative letter spacing (-10) is applied.
A line height of ___ is applied.

Tobias Light

Extended Headlines Text
Always in Light Weight

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
1234567890* @()! ?&+ -> <- ↓ ↑ ®

A b c 0 1

Sohne is used in highlighted words in
Headlines and Body text, always
in Buch (book) weight.

A negative letter spacing (-10) is applied.
A line height of ___ is applied.

Sohne Buch

Highlighted words in Headlines
& Body Text
Always in Book Weight

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
1234567890* @()! ?&+ → ← ↓ ↑ ®

Abc01

The system typeface that replaces Tobias
Light is Times New Roman Regular.

Times New Roman

Text Blocks & Secondary Text
Always in Book Weight

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
1234567890* @()! ?&+ → ← ↓ ↑ ®

A b c 0 1

Arial Regular

Text Blocks & Secondary Text

Always in Book Weight

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
1234567890* @()! ?&+ → ← ↓ ↑ ®

Abc01

Titles & Highlights

For extended headlines, the Tobias typeface is used. In shorter headlines that include concepts to be highlighted, the Sohne Buch typeface will be used to emphasize words or phrases.

The change in typeface is utilized to provide dynamism and emphasis to certain concepts in the narrative. Words that use Sohne Buch can be interpreted as independent concepts that retain their meaning even when removed from the complete sentence.

The same rule applies using system fonts: Times New Roman instead of Tobias and Arial instead of Sohne.

Body & Small Text

Being 4 the title's height, the proportion between the body text and titles height is 1 / 4.

The proportion for small text is 1 / 2 in relation with the Body text.

Use accordingly depending on communication needs.



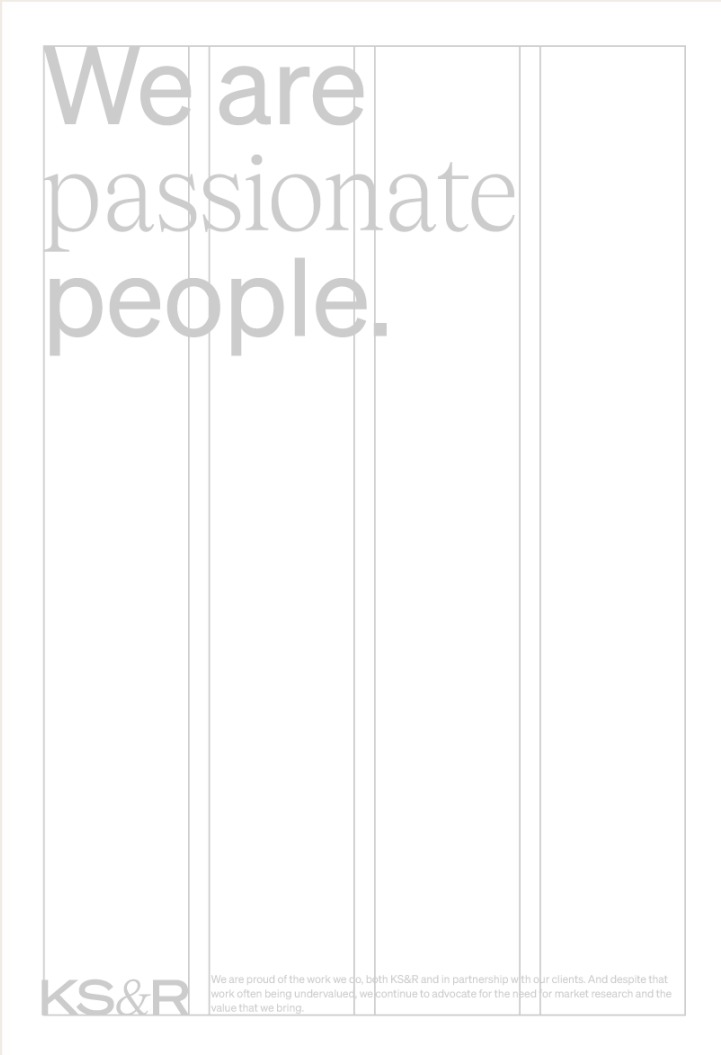
Layout Structure

Gutter size of the grid must be half of the size of the margins.

Columns are divisible by 2.

Titles and large texts always aligned with the upper margin of the design.

Small information always aligned with the lower margin of the design, distributed horizontally in equal parts and filling from the right to the left margin.



Grid

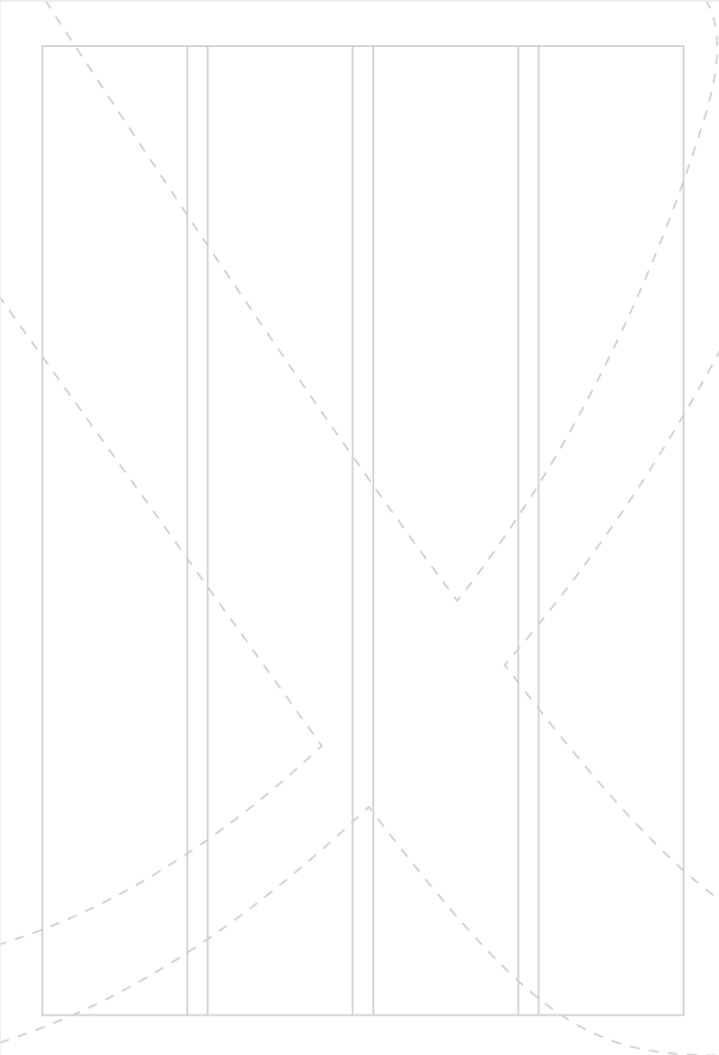


Visual

The ampersand is used as a graphic element for backgrounds.

Use only expanded to an approximate % of the layout's size.

One end of the expanded ampersand must be aligned with one of the layout's margins.



Grid



Visual

The use of fine lines helps divide the layouts in an elegant and simple way.

The line height number recommended is:

- 0.25 pt Minimum
- 1 pt Maximum

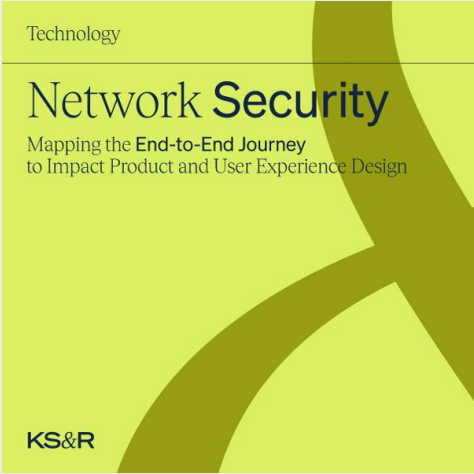
It depends on the communication piece and the dimension of the document.

Allowed uses:

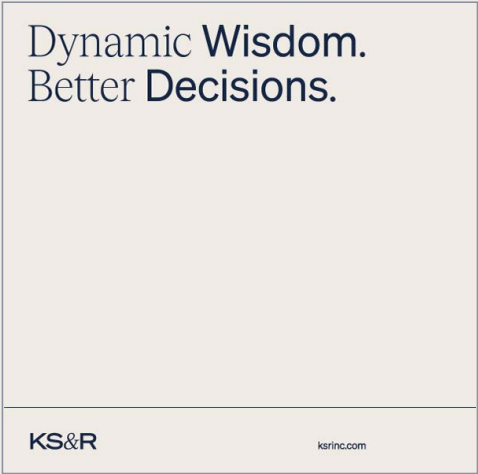
- To separate information located at the bottom from the rest of the layout
- To divide the title from the rest of the page
- To divide multiple categories



Category division



Title division

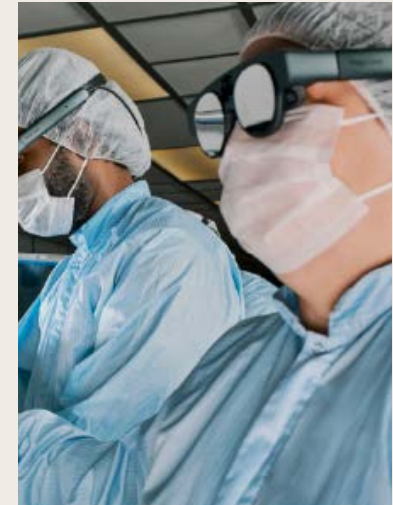


Footer

Imagery

Art direction is based on
human-centered photography.

Using pictures of objects, team, scenes,
always showing human interaction.



The ampersand is also used as a photography mask, showing people in its corner.

Dynamic **Wisdom.** Better **Decisions.**



Iconography

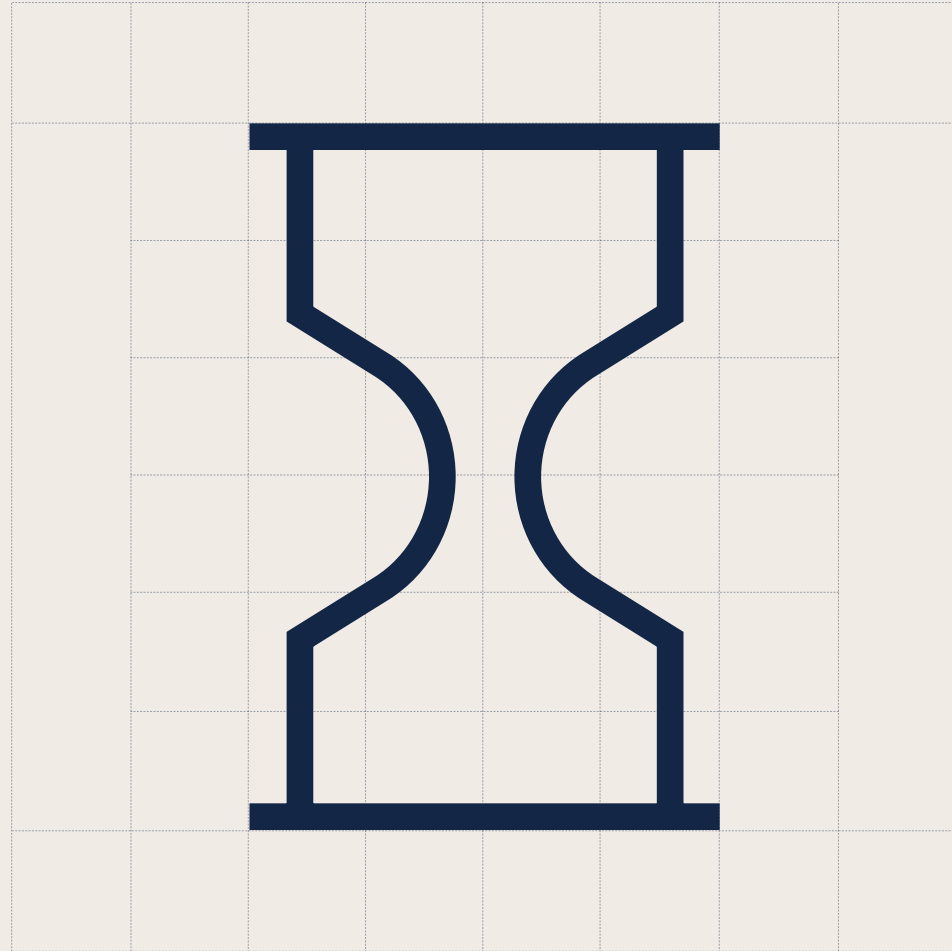
The icons need to follow the same grid and style.

The grid construction should be always with a proportion of 6×6 .

The style of iconography is outlined with a stroke of 1.5 pt.

The minimum size recommended for digital use is 20×20 px.

The minimum size recommended for digital use is 42×42 px.





Applications

KS&R

Kris Fischer

Executive Vice President & Treasurer

KS&R

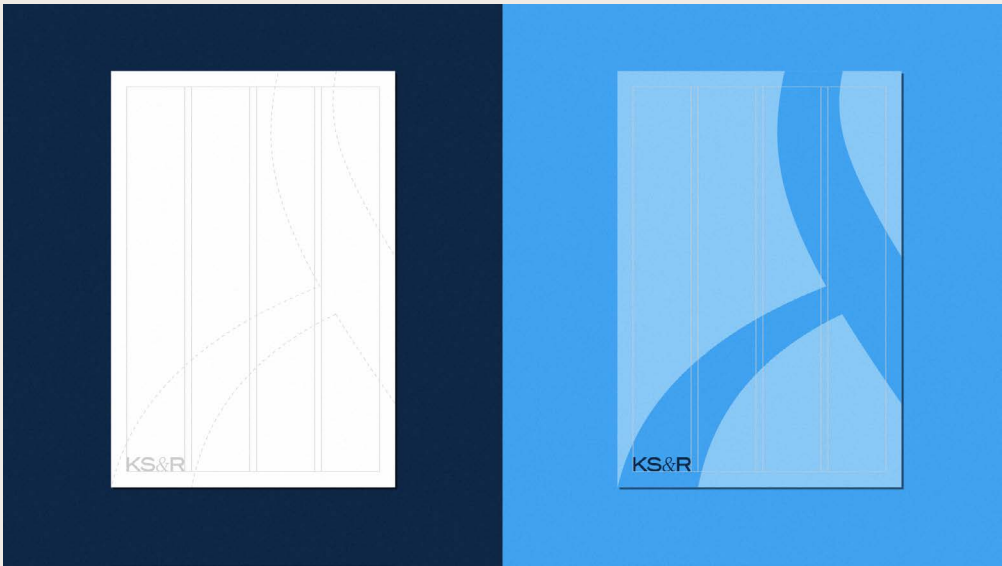
kfisher@ksrinc.com

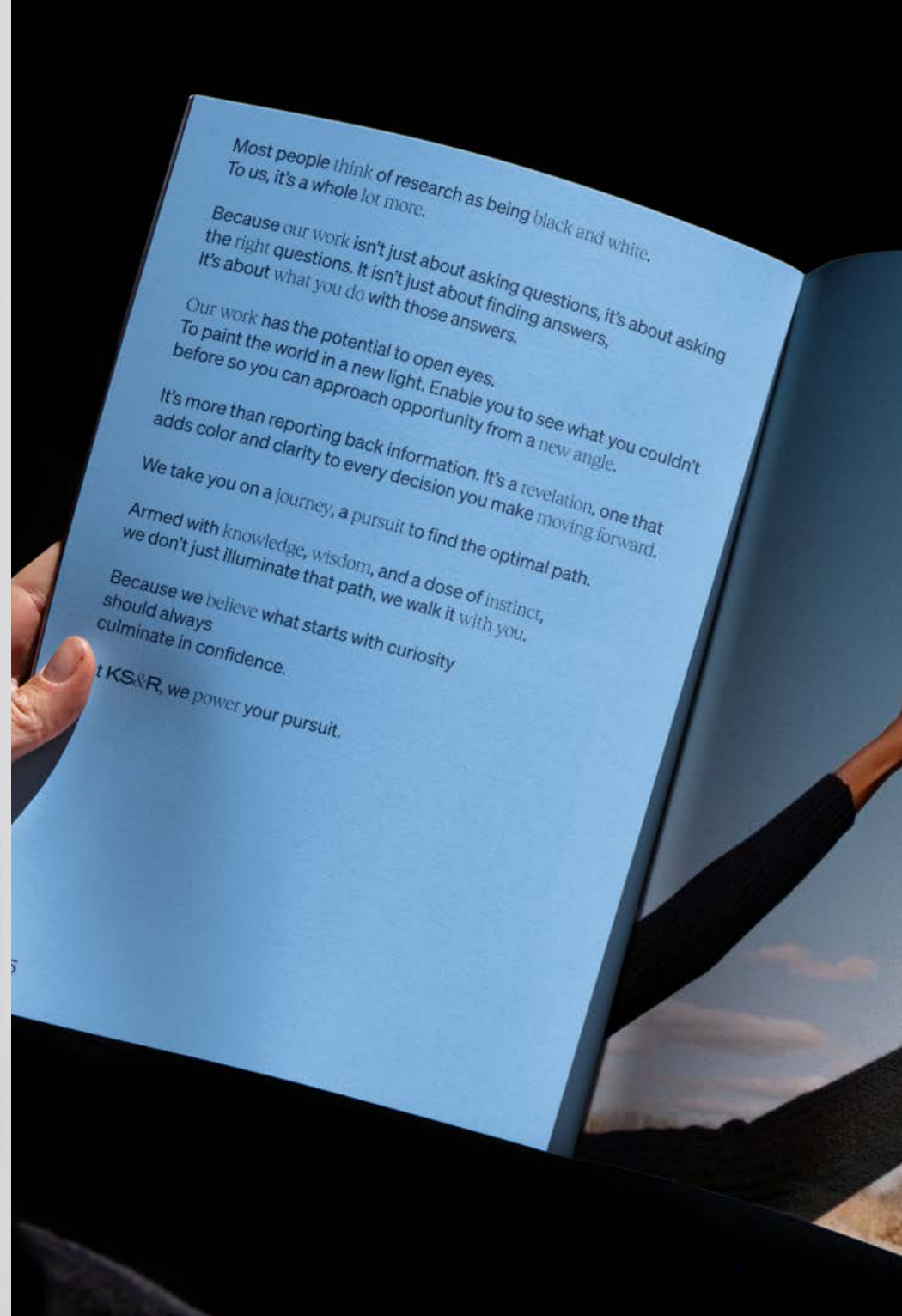
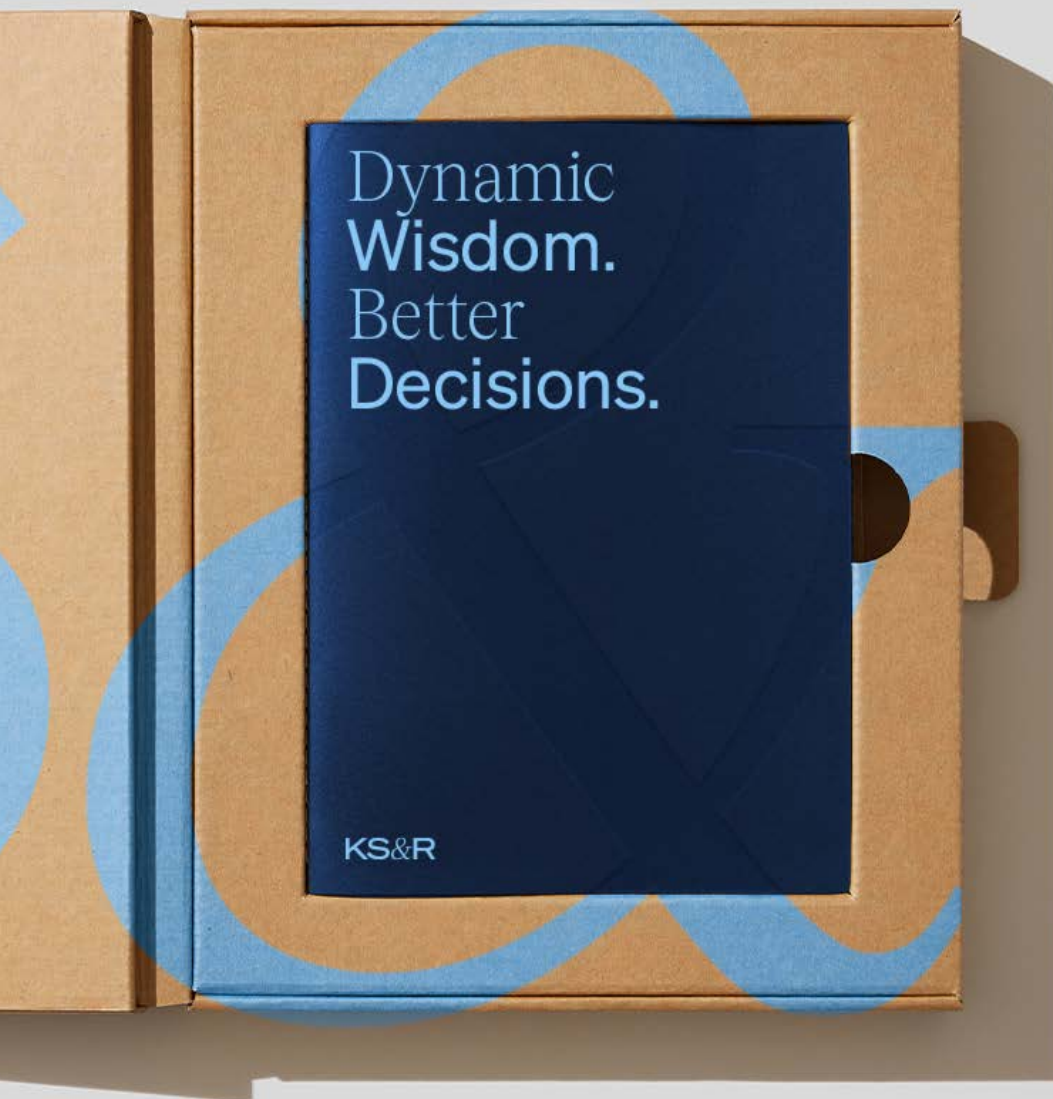
(+1) 315 470 1350

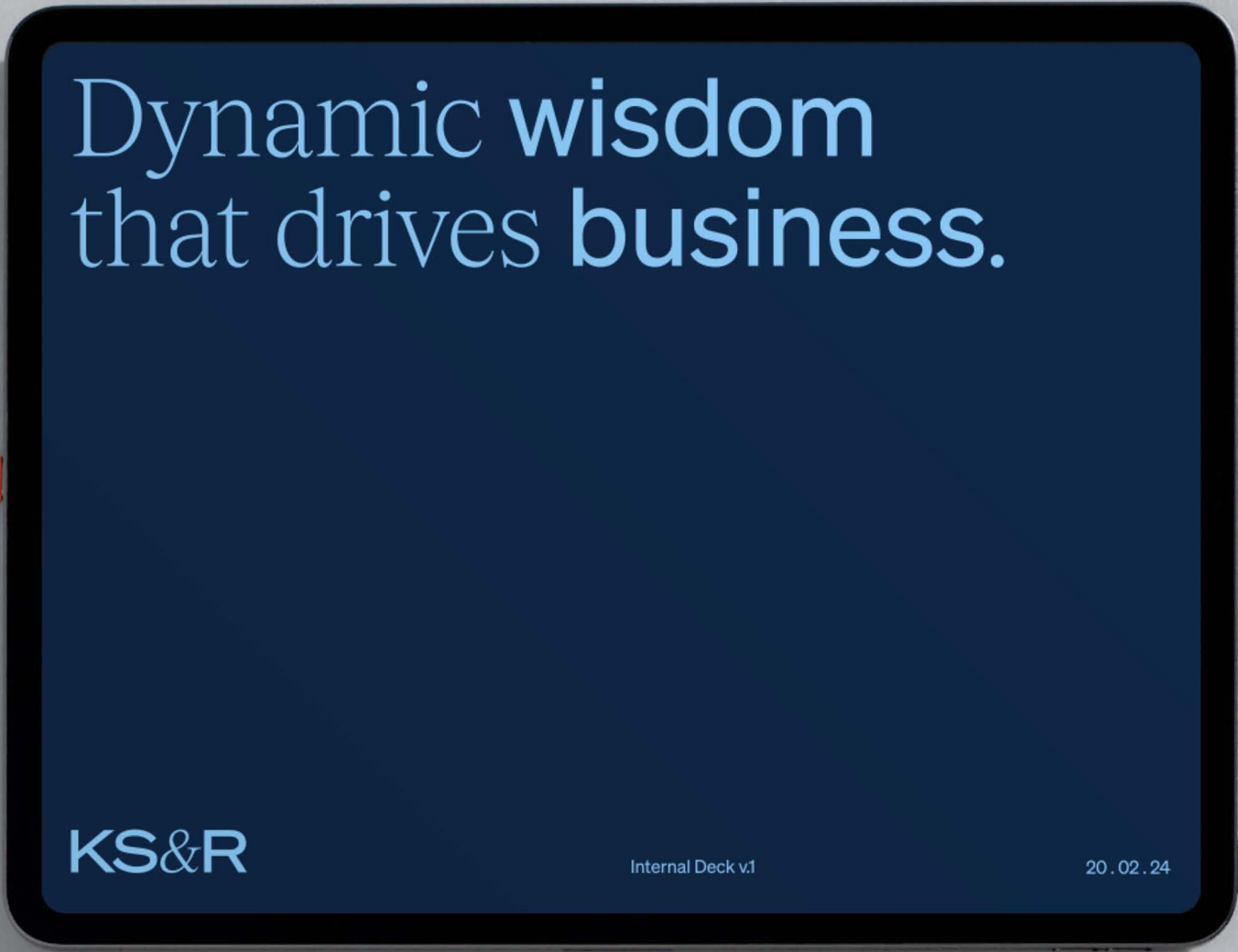
Headquarters
hq@ksrinc.com

120 Madison Street · 15th Floor
Syracuse, NY 13202









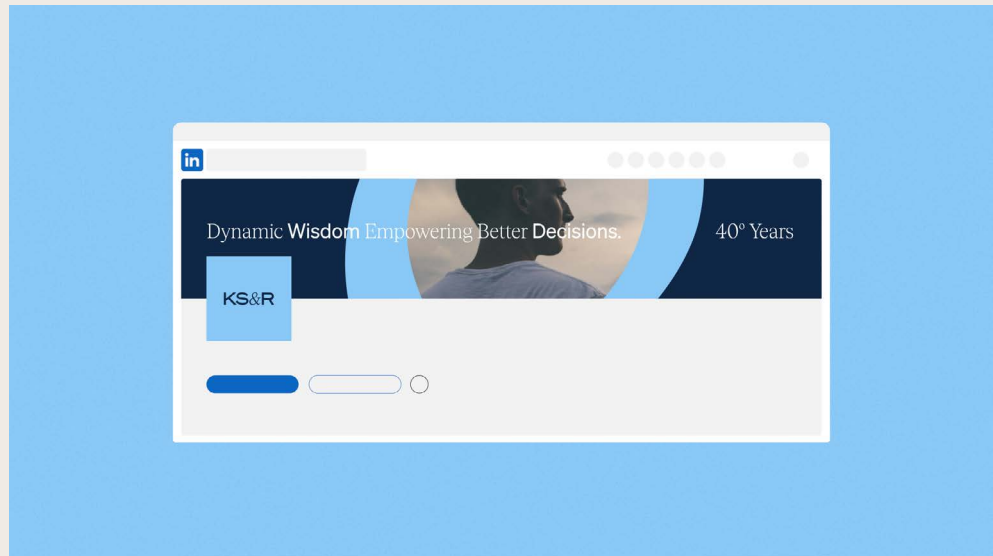
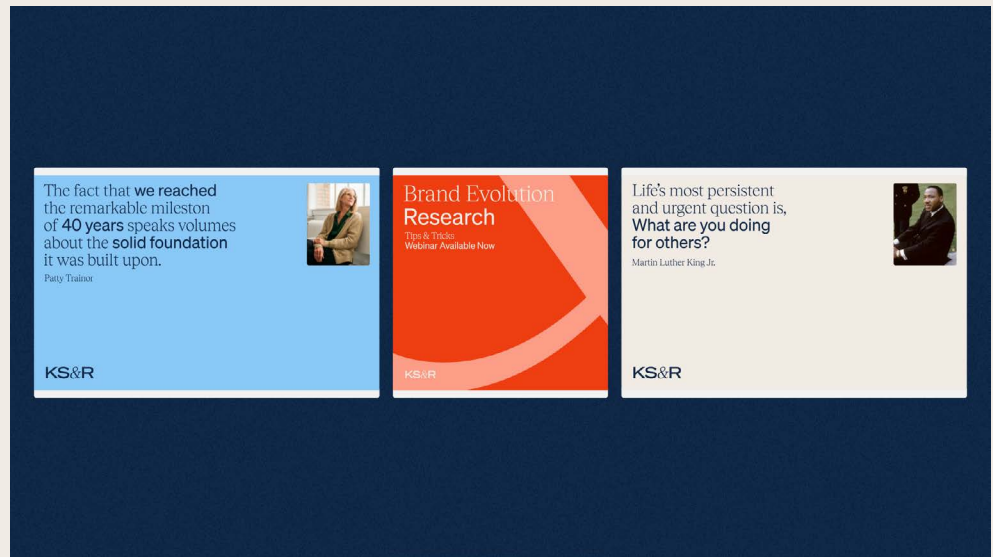
Dynamic wisdom
that drives **business.**

KS&R

Internal Deck v.1

20.02.24









Thank You.

